



CARDS AGAINST THE CLOUD

A parody party game for people who have seen the bill.

Black Cards (Prompts)

Printing this deck

100 black cards, nine per page, 12 pages of cards. Each card is 2.5 by 3.5 inches, the same size as a standard playing card.

Print at 100% scale. Turn off "fit to page" and "shrink oversized pages," which will throw off the cut lines. The card pages begin on page 2.

Black cards use full-bleed black fill, so expect to spend some toner. If your printer objects, there is a low-ink version of this game called reading the docs.

Cut along the gray grid lines. A paper trimmer will save you roughly an hour of your life compared to scissors.

Where to get the decks

Both decks and the rules live in the project repo:

<https://github.com/michaelgeiser/cards-against-the-cloud/>

Grab the latest files there. Cards get added, retired, and rewritten as new services ship and old ones get deprecated, which in this industry is roughly weekly.

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The deck is provided as-is. If a card ends a friendship or gets you invited to a conversation with HR, that is between you and the table.

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**My deployment failed
because of _____.**



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**The root cause analysis
concluded it was
_____.**



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**Why is the bill \$80,000
this month?**



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**Our disaster recovery
plan is just _____.**



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**What did the CISO find
in the S3 bucket?**



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**What's in my
Terraform state file?**



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**_____. That'll be
\$47,000.**



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**The new AWS service is
basically _____ with a
worse name.**



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**What woke me up at
3:07 a.m.?**



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**Our Kubernetes cluster
is held together by**

_____.



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**What does "cloud
native" actually mean?**



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**What did I terraform
destroy by accident?**



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**My Zero Trust architecture
consists entirely of**

_____.



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Azure is _____.



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**Google will deprecate
_____ in eighteen
months.**



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**Nobody has ever used
OCI for _____.**



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**What did the intern push
straight to main?**



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**Before you can log in,
please verify _____.**



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What's the real reason we're moving back on-prem?



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My favorite part of being on call is _____.



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AWS Support Case #8827301: "Customer reports _____."



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What does the Well-Architected Framework not cover?



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_____ is why we can't have nice things.



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The migration is 90% complete. The remaining 10% is _____.



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What does the CEO think the cloud is?



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My resume says "subject matter expert in _____."



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The vendor demo worked perfectly until _____.



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What did the AI agent do with production credentials?



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Our new AI strategy is just _____ with extra steps.



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The security audit failed because of _____.



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What am I actually thinking about during standup?



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The hackathon produced _____.



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What is the actual load-bearing component of our architecture?



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Congratulations on your promotion to Senior Director of _____.



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My therapist and I mostly talk about _____.



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What is a DevOps engineer's love language?



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us-east-1 went down and took _____ with it.



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What is the most expensive lesson I have ever learned?



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Never put _____ in a Dockerfile.



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What did the pentester find in the first five minutes?



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Slack went down and the whole company discovered _____.



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What is this year's mandatory security training about?



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What did I name the EC2 instance?



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What is the vendor's answer to every single question?



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The Gartner Magic Quadrant now has a category for _____.



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What does "serverless" really mean?



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Our compliance posture can best be described as _____.



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I passed the certification. Now I finally understand _____.



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What is the worst thing to find in a git history?



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What is in the runbook?



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The board deck says our key differentiator is _____.



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The observability dashboard shows everything except _____.



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The FinOps team would like a word with you about _____.



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What is the real reason we chose this cloud provider?



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The password policy requires one uppercase, one number, and _____.



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What is the most cursed thing in our codebase?



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Historians will remember 2026 as the year of _____.



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What did the CTO say immediately after the demo?



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Our SLA guarantees 99.99% _____.



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Instead of documentation, we have _____.



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Introducing Amazon _____, now generally available in one region.



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What killed the startup?



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What is the one question that ends every architecture review?



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After nine months, the consultants recommended _____.



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What is the DevOps equivalent of a mid-life crisis?



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Never trust a system that relies on _____.



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My infrastructure runs on caffeine, spite, and _____.



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_____: the silent killer of quarterly margins.



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The status page says "investigating elevated error rates." The truth is _____.



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What is the internet actually made of?



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Blame the outage on _____.



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What is my safe word during a Sev 1?



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What did I search for in incognito mode?



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Nothing turns me on quite like _____.



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My browser history is 90% Stack Overflow and 10% _____.



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What is trending on Hacker News?



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The LinkedIn thought leader posted a 400-word essay about _____.



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Crypto bros have officially pivoted to _____.



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The Reddit thread eventually devolved into _____.



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The dark web is currently selling _____.



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What is the sexiest thing about a well-architected system?



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What is the one thing an LLM cannot hallucinate its way out of?



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_____ plus _____ equals a three-day outage.



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PICK 2

Our incident response process: first _____, then _____.



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PICK 2

Every architecture diagram needs exactly two things: _____ and _____.



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PICK 2

The pitch deck says we are "the _____ of _____."



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PICK 2

Step one: _____. Step two: _____. Step three: profit.



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PICK 2

My side project is _____, but for _____.



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PICK 2

The new platform combines the reliability of _____ with the pricing of _____.



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PICK 2

Our multi-cloud strategy is _____ in one region and _____ in another.



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PICK 2

The postmortem timeline:
02:14 _____. 02:15
_____.



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PICK 2

The job posting requires ten
years of _____ and a
passion for _____.



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PICK 2

Nothing says "enterprise
ready" like _____ and
_____.



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PICK 2

First we tried _____.
Then, in desperation,
_____.



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PICK 2

Our security model is
_____ wrapped in
_____.



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PICK 2

The DR runbook for a regional
outage: first _____, then
_____, and finally _____.



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PICK 3

Three things are required for a
successful cloud migration:
_____, _____, and
_____.



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PICK 3

The full stack, top to
bottom: _____, _____,
and _____.



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PICK 3

My tech stack is _____,
_____, and a deep
unwillingness to change.



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PICK 2

The vendor promised _____,
delivered _____, and
invoiced us for _____.

